Specification of the controlled designation of origin "VÉZELAY"

approved by the order of 30 October 2017 published in the JORF of 9 November 2017

CHAPTER I

I. – Name of the designation

Only wines meeting the specific provisions set out below may claim the controlled designation of origin "Vézelay".

II. – Geographical denominations and complementary terms

No particular provision.

III. – Colour and types of product

The controlled designation of origin "Vézelay" is reserved for still white wines.

IV. – Areas and zones in which the various operations are carried out

1° – Geographical area

The harvesting of the grapes, the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing of the wines are carried out within the territory of the communes of Asquins, Saint-Père, Tharoiseau and Vézelay in the Yonne department.

2° – Delimited parcel area

The wines come exclusively from vines situated within the delimited parcel production area as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the session of the competent national committee of 23 November 2016.

The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town hall of the commune referred to in 1° the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production area thus approved.

3° – Immediate proximity area

The immediate proximity area, defined by derogation for the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing of the wines, is made up of the territory of the following communes:

- Côte-d'Or department: Agencourt, Aloxe-Corton, Ancey, Arcenant, Argilly, Autricourt, Auxey-Duresses, Baubigny, Beaune, Belan-sur-Ource, Bévy, Bissey-la-Côte, Bligny-lès-Beaune, Boncourt-le-Bois, Bouix, Bouze-lès-Beaune, Brion-sur-Ource, Brochon, Cérilly, Chambœuf, Chambolle-Musigny, Channay, Charrey-sur-Seine, Chassagne-Montrachet, Châtillon-sur-Seine, Chaumont-le-Bois, Chaux, Chenôve, Chevannes, Chorey-lès-Beaune, Clémencey, Collonges-lès-Bévy, Combertault, Comblanchien, Corcelles-les-Arts, Corcelles-les-Monts, Corgoloin, Cormot-le-Grand, Corpeau, Couchey, Curley, Curtil-Vergy, Daix, Dijon, Ebaty, Echevronne, Epernay-sous-Gevrey, L'Etang-Vergy, Etrochey, Fixin, Flagey-Echézeaux, Flavignerot, Fleurey-sur-Ouche, Fussey, Gerland, Gevrey-Chambertin, Gilly-lès-Cîteaux, Gommeville, Grancey-sur-Ource, Griselles, Ladoix-Serrigny, Lantenay, Larrey, Levernois, Magny-lès-Villers, Mâlain, Marcenay, Marey-lès-Fussey, Marsannay-la-Côte, Massingy, Mavilly-Mandelot, Meloisey, Merceuil, Messanges, Meuilley, Meursanges, Meursault, Molesme, Montagny-lès-Beaune, Monthelie, Montliot-et-Courcelles, Morey-Saint-Denis, Mosson, Nantoux, Nicey, Noiron-sur-Seine, Nolay, Nuits-Saint-Georges, Obtrée, Pernand-Vergelesses, Perrigny-lès-Dijon, Plombières-lès-Dijon, Poinçon-lès-Larrey, Pommard, Pothières, Premeaux-Prissey, Prusly-sur-Ource, Puligny-Montrachet, Quincey, Reulle-Vergy, La Rochepot, Ruffey-lès-Beaune, Saint-Aubin, Saint-Bernard, Saint-Philibert, Saint-Romain, Sainte-Colombe-sur-Seine, Sainte-Marie-

la-Blanche, Santenay, Savigny-lès-Beaune, Segrois, Tailly, Talant, Thoires, Vannaire, Vauchignon, Velars-sur-Ouche, Vertault, Vignoles, Villars-Fontaine, Villebichot, Villedieu, Villers-la-Faye, Villers-Patras, Villy-le-Moutier, Vix, Volnay, Vosne-Romanée and Vougeot;

- Rhône department: Alix, Anse, L'Arbresle, Les Ardillats, Arnas, Bagnols, Beaujeu, Belleville, Belmont-d'Azergues, Blacé, Le Bois-d'Oingt, Le Breuil, Bully, Cercié, Chambost-Allières, Chamelet, Charentay, Charnay, Châtillon, Chazay-d'Azergues, Chénas, Chessy, Chiroubles, Cogny, Corcelles-en-Beaujolais, Dareizé, Denicé, Dracé, Emeringes, Fleurie, Frontenas, Gleizé, Jarnioux, Juliénas, Jullié, Lacenas, Lachassagne, Lancié, Lantignié, Légny, Létra, Liergues, Limas, Lozanne, Lucenay, Marchampt, Marcy, Moiré, Montmelas-Saint-Sorlin, Morancé, Odenas, Oingt, Les Olmes, Le Perréon, Pommiers, Pouilly-le-Monial, Quincié-en-Beaujolais, Régnié-Durette, Rivolet, Saint-Clément-sur-Valsonne, Saint-Cyr-le-Chatoux, Saint-Didier-sur-Beaujeu, Saint-Etienne-des-Oullières, Saint-Etienne-la-Varenne, Saint-Georges-de-Reneins, Saint-Germain-Nuelles, Saint-Jean-d'Ardières, Saint-Jean-des-Vignes, Saint-Julien, Saint-Just-d'Avray, Saint-Lager, Saint-Laurent-d'Oingt, Saint-Loup, Sainte-Paule, Saint-Romain-de-Popey, Saint-Vérand, Salles-Arbuissonnas-en-Beaujolais, Sarcey, Taponas, Ternand, Theizé, Vaux-en-Beaujolais, Vauxrenard, Vernay, Villefranche-sur-Saône, Ville-sur-Jarnioux and Villié-Morgon;

- Saône-et-Loire department: Aluze, Ameugny, Azé, Barizey, Beaumont-sur-Grosne, Berzé-la-Ville, Berzé-le-Châtel, Bissey-sous-Cruchaud, Bissy-la-Mâconnaise, Bissy-sous-Uxelles, Bissy-sur-Fley, Blanot, Bonnay, Bouzeron, Boyer, Bray, Bresse-sur-Grosne, Burgy, Burnand, Bussières, Buxy, Cersot, Chagny, Chaintré, Chalon-sur-Saône, Chamilly, Champagny-sous-Uxelles, Champforgeuil, Chânes, Change, Chapaize, La Chapelle-de-Bragny, La Chapelle-de-Guinchay, La Chapelle-sous-Brancion, Charbonnières, Chardonnay, La Charmée, Charnay-lès-Mâcon, Charrecey, Chasselas, Chassey-le-Camp, Château, Châtenoy-le-Royal, Chaudenay, Cheilly-lès-Maranges, Chenôves, Chevagny-lès-Chevrières, Chissey-lès-Mâcon, Clessé, Cluny, Cormatin, Cortambert, Cortevaix, Couches, Crêches-sur-Saône, Créot, Cruzille, Culles-les-Roches, Curtil-sous-Burnand, Davayé, Demigny, Dennevy, Dezize-lès-Maranges, Donzy-le-National, Donzy-le-Pertuis, Dracy-le-Fort, Dracy-lès-Couches, Epertully, Etrigny, Farges-lès-Chalon, Farges-lès-Mâcon, Flagy, Fleurville, Fley, Fontaines, Fragnes-la-Loyère, Fuissé, Genouilly, Germagny, Givry, Granges, Grevilly, Hurigny, Igé, Jalogny, Jambles, Jugy, Jully-lès-Buxy, Lacrost, Laives, Laizé, Lalheue, Leynes, Lournand, Lugny, Mâcon, Malay, Mancey, Martailly-lès-Brancion, Massilly, Massy, Mellecey, Mercurey, Messey-sur-Grosne, Milly-Lamartine, Montagny-lès-Buxy, Montbellet, Montceaux-Ragny, Moroges, Nanton, Ozenay, Paris-l'Hôpital, Péronne, Pierreclos, Plottes, Préty, Prissé, Pruzilly, Remigny, La Roche-Vineuse, Romanèche-Thorins, Rosey, Royer, Rully, Saint-Albain, Saint-Ambreuil, Saint-Amour-Bellevue, Saint-Boil, Saint-Clément-sur-Guye, Saint-Denis-de-Vaux, Saint-Désert, Saint-Gengoux-de-Scissé, Saint-Gengoux-le-National, Saint-Germain-lès-Buxy, Saint-Gervais-sur-Couches, Saint-Gilles, Saint-Jean-de-Trézy, Saint-Jean-de-Vaux, Saint-Léger-sur-Dheune, Saint-Mard-de-Vaux, Saint-Martin-Belle-Roche, Saint-Martin-du-Tartre, Saint-Martin-sous-Montaigu, Saint-Maurice-de-Satonnay, Saint-Maurice-des-Champs, Saint-Maurice-lès-Couches, Saint-Pierre-de-Varennes, Saint-Rémy, Saint-Sernin-du-Plain, Saint-Symphorien-d'Ancelles, Saint-Vallerin, Saint-Vérand, Saint-Ythaire, Saisy, La Salle, Salornay-sur-Guye, Sampigny-lès-Maranges, Sancé, Santilly, Sassangy, Saules, Savigny-sur-Grosne, Sennecey-le-Grand, Senozan, Sercy, Serrières, Sigy-le-Châtel, Sologny, Solutré-Pouilly, Taizé, Tournus, Uchizy, Varennes-lès-Mâcon, Vaux-en-Pré, Vergisson, Vers, Verzé, Le Villars, La Vineuse, Vinzelles and Viré;

- Yonne department: Accolay, Aigremont, Annay-sur-Serin, Arcy-sur-Cure, Augy, Auxerre, Avallon, Bazarnes, Beine, Bernouil, Béru, Bessy-sur-Cure, Bleigny-le-Carreau, Censy, Chablis, Champlay, Champs-sur-Yonne, Champvallon, Chamvres, La Chapelle-Vaupelteigne, Charentenay, Châtel-Gérard, Chemilly-sur-Serein, Cheney, Chevannes, Chichée, Chitry, Collan, Coulangeron, Coulanges-la-Vineuse, Courgis, Cravant, Cruzy-le-Châtel, Dannemoine, Dyé, Epineuil, Escamps, Escolives-Sainte-Camille, Fleys, Fontenay-près-Chablis, Gy-l'Evêque, Héry, Irancy, Island, Joigny, Jouancy, Junay, Jussy, Lichères-près-Aigremont, Lignorelles, Ligny-le-Châtel, Lucy-sur-Cure, Maligny, Mélisey,

Merry-Sec, Migé, Molay, Molosmes, Montigny-la-Resle, Mouffy, Moulins-en-Tonnerois, Nitry, Noyers, Ouanne, Paroy-sur-Tholon, Pasilly, Pierre-Perthuis, Poilly-sur-Serein, Pontigny, Préhy, Quenne, Roffey, Rouvray, Saint-Bris-le-Vineux, Saint-Cyr-les-Colons, Sainte-Pallaye, Sainte-Vertu, Sarry, Senan, Serrigny, Tissey, Tonnerre, Tronchoy, Val-de-Mercy, Vallan, Venouse, Venoy, Vermenton, Vézannes, Vézinnes, Villeneuve-Saint-Salves, Villiers-sur-Tholon, Villy, Vincelles, Vincelottes, Viviers, Volgré and Yrouerre.

V. – Grape varieties

The wines come exclusively from the chardonnay B variety.

VI. – Management of the vineyard

1° – Training methods

a) – Planting density

The vines have a minimum planting density of 6,400 plants per hectare, with a spacing between rows less than or equal to 1.30 metres and a spacing between plants within the same row of between 1 metre and 1.20 metres.

b) – Pruning rules

The wines come from vines pruned according to the following provisions:

GENERAL PROVISIONS
The vines are pruned with a maximum of 12 free eyes per plant and a maximum of 7.5 free eyes per square metre: – either short pruning (vines trained as Royat cordon and bilateral cordon); – or single Guyot long pruning.
PARTICULAR PROVISIONS
Single Guyot pruning may be adapted: – with a 2nd spur allowing the position of the cane to be alternated from one year to the next; – with a cane shortened to a maximum of 3 free eyes and a spur limited to 2 free eyes. Whatever the pruning method, the vines may be pruned with additional free eyes provided that, at the phenological stage corresponding to 11 or 12 leaves, the number of fruit-bearing shoots of the year per plant is less than or equal to the number of free eyes defined in the pruning rules.

c) – Trellising and foliage height rules

- The height of trellised foliage is at least equal to 0.6 times the spacing between rows, the height of trellised foliage being measured between the lower limit of the foliage, set at least 0.30 metre above the ground, and the upper trimming limit;

- The vines must be raised on a stake or trellised; the trellising is maintained.

d) – Average maximum load per parcel

The average maximum load per parcel is set at 9,000 kilograms per hectare.

e) – Threshold of missing vines

The percentage of dead or missing vine plants referred to in Article D. 645-4 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is set at 20 %.

f) – Cultivation condition of the vine

The parcels are managed so as to ensure a good overall cultivation condition of the vine, in particular its sanitary condition and the upkeep of its soil.

2° – Other cultivation practices

a) – In order to preserve the characteristics of the physical and biological environment, which constitutes a fundamental element of the terroir:

- Permanent grass cover of the headlands is compulsory;

- Any substantial modification of the morphology, the subsoil, the arable layer or the elements that guarantee the integrity and sustainability of the soils of a parcel intended for the production of the controlled designation of origin is prohibited, with the exception of classic deep-ploughing works.

b) – Vine plantings and replacements are carried out with healthy plant material that has undergone hot-water treatment.

3° – Irrigation

Irrigation is prohibited.

VII. – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes

1° – Harvest

a) – The wines come from grapes harvested at good ripeness.

b) – Particular provisions for transport of the harvest

The harvest is protected from rain during its transport and on its reception.

2° – Ripeness of the grapes

a) – Sugar content of the grapes

Grapes with a sugar content of less than 178 grams per litre of must may not be considered to be at good ripeness.

b) – Minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume

The wines have a minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume of 11 %.

VIII. – Yields – Entry into production

1° – Yield

The yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is set at 55 hectolitres per hectare.

2° – Limit yield

The limit yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is set at 64 hectolitres per hectare.

3° – Entry into production of young vines

The benefit of the controlled designation of origin may only be granted to wines coming from:

- parcels of young vines only from the 2nd year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July;

- parcels of young vines only from the 1st year following that in the course of which grafting in place was carried out before 31 July;

- parcels of vines that have been top-grafted, at the earliest in the 1st year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, and once the parcels no longer contain any

varieties other than those permitted for the appellation. By derogation, in the year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, the varieties permitted for the appellation may represent only 80 % of the planting of each parcel concerned.

IX. – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage

1° – General provisions

The wines are vinified in accordance with local, fair and constant usages.

a) – Analytical standards

Finished wines, ready to be released for consumption within the meaning of D. 645-18-I of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, have a maximum fermentable sugar content (glucose + fructose) of:

- 3 grams per litre;

- or 4 grams per litre if the total acidity is greater than or equal to 55.10 milliequivalents per litre, i.e. 4.13 grams per litre expressed as tartaric acid (or 2.7 grams per litre expressed as H2SO4).

b) – Oenological practices and physical treatments

- The use of pieces of wood is prohibited;

- After enrichment, the wines do not exceed a total alcoholic strength by volume of 13 %.

c) – Prohibited equipment

Continuous presses are prohibited.

d) – Vat capacity

Every operator has an overall vat capacity (vinification and storage) equivalent to at least the volume of wine vinified for the previous year's harvest, as entered either on the harvest declaration, pro rata to the change in the holding's area in production, or on the production declaration.

e) – Upkeep of the cellar and equipment

The cellar and the equipment are well maintained; this is reflected in particular by:

- general hygiene of the elaboration premises, with general cleanliness, well-maintained floors, adequate drainage and a surface avoiding stagnation;

- harmlessness of the equipment and products coming into contact with the wine;

- separation and specificity of the premises: premises without the same functions must be separated, such as storage areas for plant-protection products, cleaning products or hydrocarbons, from the premises for vinification, ageing and storage of dry goods (corks, cartons);

- management of wine effluents: effluents must be removed as quickly as possible from foodstuff premises and deposited in well-maintained containers that are easy to clean and can be closed; waste storage areas must be kept clean; waste must be disposed of hygienically and in an environmentally friendly manner; a waste storage and removal area must be provided;

- absence of hazardous or odorous substances in the vinification, ageing and storage premises (odour).

f) – Ageing

- The wines are aged at least until 1 March of the year following that of the harvest;

- The temperature of the containers during the ageing phase is controlled and less than or equal to 25 °C.

2° – Provisions relating to packaging

For every packaged lot, the operator keeps available for the approved control body:

- the information appearing in the register of handling operations referred to in Article D. 645-18 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code;

- the reports of analyses carried out before or after packaging.

These reports are kept for a period of 6 months from the date of packaging.

3° – Provisions relating to storage

The operator provides evidence of a protected storage place for wines packaged in unlabelled bottles, with a temperature of between 5 °C and 22 °C.

4° – Provisions relating to the circulation of products and placing on the market for the consumer

At the end of the ageing period, the wines are placed on the market for the consumer from 15 March of the year following that of the harvest.

X. – Link with the geographical area

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The Vézelien region is situated on the edge of the Morvan Regional Nature Park, in the south of the Yonne department in Burgundy. A well-defined and independent geographical entity, it lies forty kilometres from the Auxerrois vineyard and about a hundred kilometres from the first vines of the Côte-d'Or. The vines are grouped on the hillsides of the communes of Asquins, Saint-Père, Tharoiseau and Vézelay, on either side of the valley of the Cure, a tributary of the Yonne.

The geographical setting in which the Vézelien vineyard has become established over the centuries is strongly marked by its morphogenesis. The final uplift of the crystalline massif of the Morvan during the Rhodanian phase (Pliocene) organised the tectonics of this setting: the Morvan then became the advanced spur of the Massif Central in the south-eastern part of the sedimentary layers of the Paris Basin.

Carved into a long sedimentary sequence in which rocks of differing resistance alternate, the funnel of the Cure appears as an amphitheatre where erosion has fashioned a succession of buttes and stepped slopes, on which southern and eastern exposures predominate. Together, these buttes and cuestas give the site of Vézelay a landscape of its own within Burgundy.

The vineyard occupies the steep slopes of the Cure and its side valleys at altitudes of between 250 and 300 metres. On the left bank, the substratum consists of Bathonian (Middle Jurassic) marls and limestones, while the slopes of the right bank consist of a predominantly marly-clayey Lias (Lower Jurassic) sequence.

The upper parts of the vineyard are characterised by shallow to moderately deep erosion soils, often stony, poor in fine earth and resting on a dislocated and weathered limestone bedrock. By contrast, on the mid-slopes and towards the foot of the slopes lie increasingly thick colluvial soils, formed by a mantle of calcareous colluvium of variable thickness and stoniness covering deep calcareous and clayey soil horizons resulting from the weathering of the various underlying rocks: hard limestones, marly limestones or marls.

The Vézelien is characterised by a cool oceanic climate reflected in frequent and abundant rainfall. With its 800 mm of rain per year, the Vézelien stands out clearly from other small wine regions of Burgundy. Owing to the proximity of the Morvan, springs are wet, summers are hot and stormy and

winters are fairly harsh, with very real risks of frost. Annual and also daily temperature ranges are wide, giving a continental note to the Vézelien climate. In winter, temperatures frequently fall to around −10 °C; in summer, temperatures of 30 °C are not rare. The average difference between daily extreme temperatures is greater in the Vézelien than in the Auxerrois, though very close by, or even in the Côte-d'Or. These differences can reach −4 °C for minimum temperatures and +8 °C for maximum temperatures.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

The presence of the vine in the Vézelien is attested from Gallo-Roman times. At the end of the 9th century, the establishment of a Benedictine monastery gave impetus to the vineyard, all the more so as, from the following century, the abbey of Vézelay became a great centre of pilgrimage and the starting point of one of the routes to Santiago de Compostela. The vineyard was reputed for its quality, as shown as early as 1137 by a charter for the payment of the cens (land tax) on vines, and by a document relating to certain parcels called Clos-au-Duc in the Nanchêvres sector of the commune of Saint-Père, property of the Duke of Burgundy.

In 1816, Jullien, in his "Topographie de tous les vignobles connus", did not fail to mention the wine of Vézelay, and in particular the parcels of the Clos de Vézelay as belonging to the third class, grouping fine wines. The wine trade of Vézelay developed until the end of the 19th century thanks to the river network that allowed it to be shipped to Paris.

Phylloxera, reaching the Auxerrois in 1884, halted this progress and reduced the vineyard area almost to nothing. For lack of manpower owing to a massive rural exodus, the reconstitution of the vineyard only began from the 1970s, driven by a handful of farmers and thanks to the support of the general councillor Paul Flandin. In 1974, a syndicate for the reconstitution of the Vézelien vineyard was created.

The first vines planted were used to experiment with varieties, planting density and training methods. Very quickly, the plantings steered the vineyard mainly towards the production of quality white wines from the chardonnay B variety, planted at high density and producing small yields. The vineyard soon became individualised within a bocage agricultural landscape.

The creation of a cooperative in 1990, whose purpose is the elaboration and marketing of the wines, greatly helped the development of viticulture. The local wine world is now made up half of cooperative members, local farmers practising mixed crop and livestock farming and viticulture on small areas. The other half is represented by winegrowers from various backgrounds, working areas of about 10 hectares, who came to settle in Vézelay to develop bottled wine sales, betting on this recent appellation and on the high tourist attendance of the site.

The inclusion of the four communes of Asquins, Saint-Père, Tharoiseau and Vézelay in the geographical area of the appellation "Bourgogne" in 1989, then the parcel delimitation of the latter in 1992, and finally the recognition of the complementary geographical denomination "Vézelay" attached to the appellation "Bourgogne" in 1998, reflect a constant search for quality among the winegrowers of the Vézelien.

In the ten years following the recognition of the denomination, the winegrowers constantly sought to improve, pushing production constraints and checks even further than the strict requirements of the specification.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

The appellation "Vézelay" is a dry white wine, pale golden-yellow in colour, produced from the chardonnay B variety. It is characterised by a floral character supported by great freshness and minerality on the palate. It gains in complexity and finesse with age.

3° – Causal interactions

The geographical independence of the Vézelien, remote both from the terroirs of the Auxerrois to the north and from the Côte-d'Or to the south, as well as the singularity of its geology, make it a unique wine region.

Despite its near disappearance following the phylloxera crisis, the vineyard of Vézelay has a long history going back to Roman times. This continuity bears witness to the particular aptitude of this site, on the banks of the Cure where it emerges from the Morvan, to produce quality wines.

The calcareous to marly-calcareous hillsides of the Vézelien, on which grow the vines delimited for the appellation "Vézelay", are exposed from south-east to south-west and are sheltered from cold north winds. These conditions are favourable to the cultivation of chardonnay, the traditional Burgundy variety.

The local climate, influenced by the proximity of the Morvan massif made up of high wooded hills, preserves the acidity of the harvest and gives more freshness to these white wines, which thus stand apart from other white wines of Burgundy. The surrounding landscape elements (relief, proximity of the Morvan forests) also contribute to this freshness on the palate. These characteristics, due to the cooler local climate, distinguish the wines of Vézelay from other white wines of Burgundy, in particular by developing aromas of white flowers (acacia and hawthorn).

In the vineyard, the Burgundian growing tradition is respected: high planting density, short pruning, trellising. The vinification methods and the relatively short ageing periods lead to the particular expression of the wines of the AOC "Vézelay", whose freshness, minerality and floral aromas are the main organoleptic characteristics.

The vineyard has gradually regained its place in the landscapes of the Vézelien, occupying the most favourable situations. The prestigious site of the basilica of Vézelay thus shows a very Burgundian face, dotted with both vines and pastures.

XI. – Transitional measures

No particular provision.

XII. – Rules of presentation and labelling

1° – General provisions

Wines for which, under the terms of the present specification, the controlled designation of origin "Vézelay" is claimed and which are presented under the said appellation may not be declared after the harvest, offered to the public, dispatched, put up for sale or sold unless, in the harvest declaration, in advertisements, on leaflets, labels, invoices and any containers whatsoever, the aforesaid controlled designation of origin is entered.

2° – Particular provisions

a) – The labelling of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin may specify the name of a smaller geographical unit, provided that:

- it is the name of a registered lieu-dit (cadastral locality);

- it appears on the harvest declaration.

The name of the registered lieu-dit is printed in characters whose dimensions, both in height and in width, are not larger than half those of the characters making up the name of the controlled designation of origin.

b) – The labelling of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin may specify the larger geographical unit “Vin de Bourgogne” or “Grand Vin de Bourgogne”.

c) – Where the grape variety is indicated on the labelling, this indication does not appear in the same field of vision as the compulsory particulars and is printed in characters whose dimensions do not exceed 2 millimetres.

CHAPTER II

I. – Declaration obligations

1. Claim declaration

The claim declaration is sent to the defence and management body at least fifteen days before circulation between authorised warehousekeepers and at the latest on 10 December of the year of harvest.

It indicates in particular:

- the designation claimed;

- the volume of the wine;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the name and address of the applicant;

- the place of storage of the wine.

It is accompanied in particular by a copy of the harvest declaration and, as the case may be, a copy of the production declaration or an extract of the stock accounts for buyers of grapes and musts.

2. Declaration prior to transaction and collections

Every operator wishing to sell in bulk a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin makes a transaction declaration for the lot concerned to the approved control body within time limits set in the control plan of between six and fifteen working days before any collection.

This declaration, accompanied where applicable by a copy of the purchase contract, specifies in particular:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the identification of the lot;

- the volume of the lot;

- the identification of the containers;

- the identity of the buyer.

If collections are made for volumes smaller than those set out in the transaction declaration, the operator informs the approved control body in writing.

3. Declaration of release for consumption

Every operator declares to the approved control body each lot of wine intended to be released for consumption within the meaning of Article D. 645-18-I of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code.

This declaration may also be drawn up for lots already packaged. It is made within time limits set in the control plan of between six and fifteen working days before release for consumption or before the

lots concerned are dispatched from the operator's cellars.

It specifies in particular:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the identification of the lot;

- the volume of the lot;

- the lot number for wines already packaged;

- the identification of the containers for non-packaged wines.

However, making available to the approved control body the register referred to in Article D. 645-18 II of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code serves as the declaration of release for consumption, under the conditions set out in the control plan.

4. Declaration relating to the dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine

Every operator wishing to dispatch outside the national territory a non-packaged wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin declares it to the approved control body within time limits set in the control plan of between six and fifteen working days before any dispatch.

5. Fallback declaration

Every operator carrying out a fallback of a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin into a more general controlled designation of origin sends the defence and management body and the approved control body a monthly declaration at the latest on the 1st working day following the tenth day of each month.

This declaration indicates in particular:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the more general controlled designation of origin of the fallback;

- the volume concerned by the fallback;

- the vintage;

- the state of the lot concerned (bulk, bottle, hermetically sealed vacuum containers…).

The approved control body transmits without delay a copy of the monthly declaration to the approved control body for the more general controlled designation of origin concerned.

The defence and management body transmits without delay to the defence and management body of the more general controlled designation of origin concerned the list of operators who have made a monthly fallback declaration, together with a summary statement indicating:

- the more general controlled designation of origin of the fallback;

- the volume concerned by the fallback;

- the vintage(s);

- the state of the lot(s) concerned (bulk, bottle, hermetically sealed vacuum containers…).

6. Downgrading declaration

Every operator carrying out a downgrading of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin sends the defence and management body and the approved control body a monthly declaration within time limits set in the control plan. This declaration indicates in particular:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the volume downgraded;

- the vintage;

- the date of the downgrading.

7. Reworking of parcels

Before any development or any works liable to modify the morphology, the subsoil, the arable layer (including any addition of exogenous soil) or the elements that guarantee the integrity and sustainability of the soils of a parcel intended for the production of the controlled designation of origin, with the exception of classic deep-ploughing works, the operator sends a declaration to the defence and management body at least four weeks before the planned start date of the works.

The defence and management body transmits, without delay, a copy of this declaration to the services of the National Institute of Origin and Quality.

II. – Keeping of registers

General plan of the storage and vinification places

Every vinifying operator keeps up to date and available for the approved control body a general plan of the storage and vinification places, allowing in particular the number, designation and capacity of the containers to be identified.

CHAPTER III

I. – Main points to be checked and evaluation methods

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
A – STRUCTURAL RULES	
A1 – Location of operators within the immediate proximity area	Documentary check
A2 – Belonging of the planted parcels to the delimited area	– Documentary check: up-to-date CVI parcel record; – Check in the field
A3 – Claimable production potential (grape varieties and proportion rules, planting density, plant material)	– Documentary check; – Check in the field
A4 – Processing, ageing, packaging and storage facilities	
Vat capacity	– Documentary check: general plan of the storage places; – On-site check
Ageing (temperature control and length of ageing)	– Documentary check: declaration of release for consumption or bottling register; – On-site check
State of upkeep of the cellar and equipment (hygiene)	On-site check

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
Protected storage place and storage conditions (T °C)	On-site check
B – RULES LINKED TO THE PRODUCTION CYCLE	
B1 – Management of the vineyard	
Pruning	Check in the field
Average maximum load per parcel	Check in the field
Cultivation and sanitary condition of the vine (sanitary condition of foliage and berries, upkeep of the soil, upkeep of the trellising)	Check in the field
B2 – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes	
Ripeness of the grapes	– Documentary check: records of ripeness monitoring; – Check in the field
B3 – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage	
Oenological practices or treatments (enrichment, prohibited practices…)	– Documentary check: enrichment, acidification and de-acidification register; – On-site check
Stock accounts, analytical traceability	Documentary check: keeping of registers, analysis reports
B4 – Harvest declaration and claim declaration	
Missing vines	– Documentary check (keeping the list up to date); – Check in the field
Authorised yield	Documentary check: check of declarations, monitoring of authorisations granted by the INAO services after their investigation of the operator's individual request
VSI, volumes harvested in excess of the authorised yield	Documentary check: monitoring of destruction certificates
Claim declaration	– Documentary and on-site check: compliance with procedures and time limits, consistency with the harvest and production declarations; – Check of the release of products into circulation
C – CHECKS ON THE PRODUCTS	
Non-packaged wines (at transaction or collection)	Analytical and organoleptic examination
Packaged wines (before or after preparation for release for consumption)	Analytical and organoleptic examination
Non-packaged wines intended for dispatch outside the national territory	Analytical and organoleptic examination of all lots
D – PRESENTATION OF THE PRODUCTS	
Labelling	On-site check

II. – References concerning the control structure

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Compliance with the present specification is checked by a third-party body offering guarantees of competence, impartiality and independence, on behalf of the INAO, on the basis of an approved control plan.

The control plan recalls the self-checks carried out by operators on their own activity and the internal checks carried out under the responsibility of the defence and management body. It indicates the external checks carried out by the third-party body as well as the analytical and organoleptic examinations.

All checks are carried out by sampling. Non-packaged wines intended for dispatch outside the national territory are subject to systematic analytical and organoleptic checks.